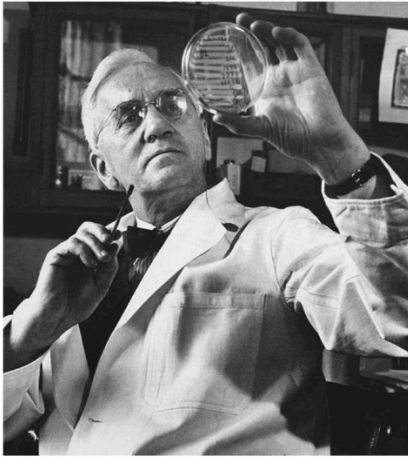
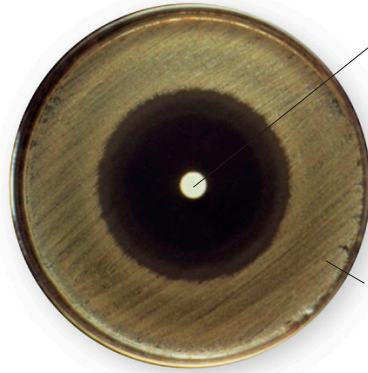




Sir Alexander Fleming (1881–1955)

Penicillin

In 1928, the Scottish scientist Sir Alexander Fleming made an important discovery. He realized that the mold *Penicillium notatum* makes a chemical that kills bacteria. That chemical, called penicillin, is used today as a medicine to treat many illnesses.



Penicillin on a petri dish

The bacteria have retreated from the penicillin, leaving a clear ring.

Truffles

Truffles are strong-smelling fungi that grow underground. They are a delicacy used in cooking. Truffle hunters use pigs and dogs to sniff them out.



Pig sniffing out mushroom



White truffle



Black perigord truffle



Yeast

Yeast are microscopic, single-celled fungi. When they feed, they turn sugar into the gas carbon dioxide and alcohol. Yeast plays an important part in bread-making. As it releases gas, it makes bread rise.

Shaggy parasol mushroom

Shaggy cap mushroom

Common chanterelle mushroom

Chicken of the woods mushroom



Uses of fungi

Fungi have many uses in the home and in industry.



Medicinal fungi can be used to cure many diseases that were once fatal.



Wine is made from grape juice when yeast turns the sugar in the juice into alcohol.



Blue cheese is made with a mold called *Penicillium roquefortii*.



Soy sauce is made by adding fungi and yeast to soy beans and roasted wheat.



Pesticidal fungi can be an environmentally friendly way of killing insects or weeds.